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POSTOPERATIVE REHABILIATION PROTOCOL

HIP ARTHROSCOPY with GLUTEUS MEDIUS REPAIR

OVERVIEW

Phase I (Weeks 1-6):
Hip brace with ambulation x 4 weeks, 20# weight bearing with foot flat pattern during walking x 6 weeks, avoid hip flexor irritation, PROM and AROM exercises within limitations, isometric strength gains to focus on muscle firing patterns, encourage prone lying 2-3 hours a day

Phase II (Weeks 7-9):
Wean from crutches, normalize gait pattern, restore full AROM and PROM gradually, initiate closed chain exercises and weight shifting exercises

Phase III (Weeks 10-15):
Begin resisted biking, progress strengthening exercises from double to single leg, focus on return to prior activities without pain or irritation, progress lower extremity strength and endurance

Phase IV (Months 4-6):
Begin return to running program; functional strengthening and agility; return to sport exercises

Home program:
Continue through 1 year

Progression of activities:

- *Crutches:* 20# WB with foot flat walking pattern x 6 weeks, then progress to full WB
- *Hip brace:* Wear hip brace while ambulating x 4 weeks
- *Driving:* Avoid driving until you are no longer taking narcotic pain medication, are able to actively lift leg (around 3 weeks) and have the necessary limb control to perform all driving tasks.
- *Aqua therapy:* May begin after week 3 once incisions have healed
- *Running:* Wait until 3 months before beginning running progression

- **This protocol is non-linear**
- **Patients may progress at different rates. Do not push through the pain**
- **Please use clinical judgement and tailor to each patient's needs**

PHASE I: PROTECTION AND ROM (WEEKS 1-6)

GOALS

- Protect repair
- Avoid active hip abduction, passive hip adduction
- Avoid hip flexor irritation (no sitting with hip flexed >90 degrees)
- Control and decrease pain, inflammation, swelling, or effusion
- Avoid adhesion formation with passive motion and soft tissue mobilization
- Hip brace when ambulating for 4 weeks
- 20lb Weight bearing with foot flat gait pattern x 6 weeks, then WBAT
- ROM restrictions: Abduction to 45 (passive ONLY), no extension past 0, ER past 30

EXERCISES

WEEK 1

Hamstring sets and seated hamstring stretch
Prone hangs, prone lying 2-3 hours a day
Ankle pumps
Supine PROM
- Flexion to 75, Abduction to 30, ER and IR to 20 (with hip flexed)
- 30 reps of each plane of motion

Log rolls
Isometrics (focus on transabdominals, obliques, gluteals, abductors)

WEEK 2

Continue week 1 exercises
Circumduction
- Hip flexed to 70, knee flexed to 90. Gently move the thigh in small circular movements (first clockwise, then counter-clockwise)
- Avoid ER/IR
- Perform for 5 minutes in each direction.
- Repeat again in neutral (hip abducted 20 degrees, knee extended)

Stationary bike, no resistance, keep seat high, no recumbent bike
Quadruped progression (be mindful of ROM restrictions)
- Cat and camel
- Rockback (with slight posterior tilt)
- Hip extensions

Soft tissue mobilization (start superficial, progress to deep)
Scar massage at portal incisions x 5 minutes

WEEK 3-6

Continue week 2 exercises
Begin aquatic therapy (as long as incisions are well-healed)
Double leg bridges
Stool rotations (within ROM restrictions)
Physioball rollouts

Criteria to progress

Well-controlled postoperative pain
No frontal/sagittal plane deviations of hip and pelvis when ambulating

PHASE II: STABILITY AND GAIT (WEEKS 7-9)

GOALS

- Protect repair
- Normalize gait pattern
- Initiate closed chain and weight shift exercises
- Continue with phase I exercises as appropriate

EXERCISES

WEEK 7 Wean from crutches, normalize gait pattern
Stationary bike, no resistance, keep seat high, no recumbent bike

WEEK 8 Sidelying clam shells (progress to TheraBand resistance)
Standing hip abduction isometrics (foam roller or against wall)

WEEK 9 Bilateral low-weight leg press
Advance quadriceps/hamstring strengthening
Side step-ups
Y balance reaching
Balance and proprioceptive training (Bosu ball, balance board, single leg stance)
Begin elliptical

Criteria to progress

No gait deviations
Minimal pain following activities
ROM equal to contralateral side

PHASE III: STRENGTH AND MUSCULAR ENDURANCE (WEEKS 10-16)

GOALS

- Prevent compensation due to fatigue
- Begin resisted biking
- Progress strengthening exercises from double to single leg
- Focus on return to prior activities without pain or irritation
- Progress lower extremity strength and endurance

EXERCISES

WEEKS 10-16 Continue all appropriate exercises from phase II
Low-weight unilateral leg press
Half prone plank/pillar bridge (progress to full/bosu when appropriate)
Double leg body weight squats
Single leg quarter-squat
Forward/lateral/reverse lunges
Begin Abductor/IT band/Glut-Max stretching

Cardiovascular Exercises
Elliptical trainer (start with 5 minutes, increase 5 minutes each week)
Resisted biking (advance resistance as tolerated)

TRANSITION TO HEP OR FURTHER THERAPY AS NEEDED

Maintenance program for strength, endurance, and proprioception